CULTIVATION GUIDE | FERTILISER SCHEDULES

Paddy Fertiliser Schedules by Zone and Water Regime

The four general schedules in the Department of Agriculture's 2013 fertiliser recommendation for rice, with the districts each applies to.

Document AV-CG-06 | Category: cultivation_guide | DOA/RRDI 2013 recommendation, web tables checked 3 Oct 2026
Teaching edition for the STEMLink AI Engineer Bootcamp, compiled from official Sri Lankan sources (Department of Agriculture and RRDI web pages, Agricultural and Agrarian Insurance Board, Cabinet decisions as reported), accessed 3 October 2026. Sources are listed in the corpus README, not in this document.

PERMITTED USE OF THESE SCHEDULES

Orientation in time only. A crop's age tells you which application it is approaching, so a farmer's question becomes one of timing. These figures must not be restated to a farmer as an instruction, scaled to a field's size, or adjusted for observed symptoms. The Grama Niladhari division recommendation, and soil test or leaf colour chart based recommendations, take precedence.

The Department of Agriculture (DOA) and the Rice Research and Development Institute (RRDI) publish four general schedules: Intermediate and Dry Zone irrigated, Intermediate and Dry Zone rainfed, Wet Zone irrigated, and Wet Zone rainfed. All figures are kilograms per hectare, timed from the date of establishment. The DOA also publishes recommendations based on soil analysis reports, the soil test kit and leaf colour index values, and a map based recommendation for Anuradhapura, Polonnaruwa and Kurunegala districts.

HOW THESE TABLES WERE TRANSCRIBED

The DOA web tables list the numbers for each timing without marking which fertiliser column each number belongs to. The column assignment here was reconstructed so that every season total on the web page reconciles exactly. It still needs checking against the 2013 fertiliser recommendation booklet (AV-POL-03, item V1).

1. Intermediate Zone and Dry Zone, irrigated

Applies to: Anuradhapura, Polonnaruwa, Monaragala, Hambantota, Mullaitivu, Jaffna, Kurunegala, Mannar, Puttalam, Trincomalee, Kilinochchi and Badulla districts; Kandy for the Minipe, Udadumbara, Panwila, Medadumbara, Kundasale, Pathahewaheta and Delthota divisional secretariats; Nuwara Eliya for Hanguranketha and Walapane; Ratnapura for Embilipitiya, Kolonna, Balangoda, Imbulpe and Weligepola; Matara for Hakmana, Kirinda, Devinuwara, Dikwella, Thihagoda and Kamburupitiya; Matale except Yatawatta and Ukuwela.

Ampara, Batticaloa and Vavuniya appear on the Intermediate and Dry Zone rainfed list but not on this irrigated list. An irrigated field in those districts should be referred to its Grama Niladhari division recommendation (AV-POL-03, item V6).

Table 1. Intermediate and Dry Zone, irrigated (kg/ha from establishment)

Basal. 3-month variety: TSP 55, $ZnSO_4$ 5; 3½-month variety: TSP 55, $ZnSO_4$ 5; 4-month variety: TSP 55, $ZnSO_4$ 5.
2 weeks. 3-month variety: Urea 50; 3½-month variety: Urea 50; 4-month variety: Urea 50.
4 weeks. 3-month variety: Urea 75, MOP 25; 3½-month variety: Urea 75, MOP 25; 4-month variety: Urea 75, MOP 25.
6 weeks. 3-month variety: Urea 65, MOP 35; 3½-month variety: Urea 65, MOP 35; 4-month variety: none.
7 weeks. 3-month variety: Urea 35; 3½-month variety: none; 4-month variety: Urea 65, MOP 35.
8 weeks. 3-month variety: none; 3½-month variety: Urea 35; 4-month variety: none.

9 weeks. 3-month variety: none; 3½-month variety: none; 4-month variety: Urea 35.
Season total. 3-month variety: Urea 225, TSP 55, MOP 60, $ZnSO_4$ 5; 3½-month variety: Urea 225, TSP 55, MOP 60, $ZnSO_4$ 5; 4-month variety: Urea 225, TSP 55, MOP 60, $ZnSO_4$ 5.

2. Intermediate Zone and Dry Zone, rainfed

Applies to: Anuradhapura, Polonnaruwa, Monaragala, Hambantota, Mullaitivu, Jaffna, Kurunegala, Puttalam, Mannar, Vavuniya, Ampara, Batticaloa, Trincomalee, Kilinochchi and Badulla districts, and the same divisional secretariats of Kandy, Nuwara Eliya, Ratnapura and Matara as the irrigated schedule; Matale for Yatawatta and Ukuwela.

The rainfed Intermediate and Dry Zone schedule covers three month and three and a half month varieties only. No four month schedule is published for this zone and water regime.

Table 2. Intermediate and Dry Zone, rainfed (kg/ha from establishment)

Basal. 3-month variety: TSP 35, $ZnSO_4$ 5; 3½-month variety: TSP 35, $ZnSO_4$ 5.
2 weeks. 3-month variety: Urea 30; 3½-month variety: Urea 30.
4 weeks. 3-month variety: Urea 65, MOP 25; 3½-month variety: Urea 65, MOP 25.
6 weeks. 3-month variety: Urea 50, MOP 25; 3½-month variety: Urea 50, MOP 25.
7 weeks. 3-month variety: Urea 30; 3½-month variety: none.
8 weeks. 3-month variety: none; 3½-month variety: Urea 30.
Season total. 3-month variety: Urea 175, TSP 35, MOP 50, $ZnSO_4$ 5; 3½-month variety: Urea 175, TSP 35, MOP 50, $ZnSO_4$ 5.

3. Wet Zone, irrigated

Applies to: Kegalle, Gampaha, Colombo, Galle and Kalutara districts; Matale for Yatawatta and Ukuwela; Kandy except the Minipe, Udadumbara, Panwila, Medadumbara, Kundasale, Pathahewaheta and Delthota divisional secretariats; Nuwara Eliya except Hanguranketha and Walapane; Matara except Hakmana, Kirinda, Devinuwara, Dikwella, Thihagoda and Kamburupitiya; Ratnapura except Embilipitiya, Kolonna, Balangoda, Imbulpe and Weligepola.

Table 3. Wet Zone, irrigated (kg/ha from establishment)

Basal. 3-month variety: TSP 35, $ZnSO_4$ 5; 3½-month variety: TSP 35 (the web table omits $ZnSO_4$ here; its season total includes 5); 4-month variety: TSP 35, $ZnSO_4$ 5.
2 weeks. 3-month variety: Urea 20; 3½-month variety: Urea 20; 4-month variety: Urea 20.
4 weeks. 3-month variety: Urea 55, MOP 25; 3½-month variety: Urea 55, MOP 25; 4-month variety: Urea 55, MOP 25.
6 weeks. 3-month variety: Urea 45, MOP 25; 3½-month variety: Urea 45, MOP 25; 4-month variety: none.
7 weeks. 3-month variety: Urea 20; 3½-month variety: none; 4-month variety: Urea 45, MOP 25.
8 weeks. 3-month variety: none; 3½-month variety: Urea 20; 4-month variety: none.
9 weeks. 3-month variety: none; 3½-month variety: none; 4-month variety: Urea 20.
Season total. 3-month variety: Urea 140, TSP 35, MOP 50, $ZnSO_4$ 5; 3½-month variety: Urea 140, TSP 35, MOP 50, $ZnSO_4$ 5; 4-month variety: Urea 140, TSP 35, MOP 50, $ZnSO_4$ 5.

4. Wet Zone, rainfed

Applies to: Kegalle, Gampaha, Colombo and Kalutara districts, and the same parts of Matale, Kandy, Nuwara Eliya, Matara and Ratnapura as the Wet Zone irrigated schedule. Galle district is listed for the irrigated schedule only.

Table 4. Wet Zone, rainfed (kg/ha from establishment)

Basal. 3-month variety: TSP 55, $ZnSO_4$ 5; 3½-month variety: TSP 55, $ZnSO_4$ 5; 4-month variety: TSP 55, $ZnSO_4$ 5.
2 weeks. 3-month variety: Urea 25, MOP 35; 3½-month variety: Urea 25, MOP 35; 4-month variety: Urea 25, MOP 35.
4 weeks. 3-month variety: Urea 30, MOP 45; 3½-month variety: Urea 30, MOP 45; 4-month variety: Urea 30, MOP 45.
6 weeks. 3-month variety: Urea 25, MOP 30; 3½-month variety: Urea 25, MOP 30; 4-month variety: none.
7 weeks. 3-month variety: Urea 20; 3½-month variety: none; 4-month variety: Urea 25, MOP 30.
8 weeks. 3-month variety: none; 3½-month variety: Urea 20; 4-month variety: none.
9 weeks. 3-month variety: none; 3½-month variety: none; 4-month variety: Urea 20.
Season total. 3-month variety: Urea 100, TSP 55, MOP 110, $ZnSO_4$ 5; 3½-month variety: Urea 100, TSP 55, MOP 110, $ZnSO_4$ 5; 4-month variety: Urea 100, TSP 55, MOP 110, $ZnSO_4$ 5.

5. Reading the schedules together

Every schedule splits nitrogen (urea) into top dressings at two and four weeks, then one or two later dressings whose timing depends on the varietal age class: six and seven weeks for three month varieties, six and eight weeks for three and a half month varieties, seven and nine weeks for four month varieties. Rainfed schedules carry less urea than irrigated ones in the same zone, and Wet Zone schedules less than Intermediate and Dry Zone ones. Zinc sulphate is applied once a year.